

Word family: image / imagery / imaging / imagine / imagination / imaginary

Base word: image

Plural: images

Related forms: imagery, imaging

Useful family extensions: imagine, imagination, imaginary, self-image, public image, brand image, mirror image

Part of speech: mainly noun (名詞) / also verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

“That image really stayed with me.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, image does not mean an actual photograph or picture.

It means a vivid mental picture or idea created in your mind by the metaphor of someone pressing a mute button on the outside world.

繁體中文：由某個描述或比喻在腦海中形成的鮮明畫面或意象，令人很容易想像並留下深刻印象

中文翻譯：

“That image really stayed with me.”

「那個在腦海中形成的鮮明意象真的令我印象很深，一直留在我的記憶中。」

Here:

“pressing a mute button on the outside world”

creates the image:

彷彿整個外界真的有一個「靜音鍵」，而有人把它按下。

1. image = picture/visual representation (照片／圖像／畫面) — 圖像；影像；圖片

Meaning: A visual representation of a person, object, scene, etc., such as a photograph, drawing, or digital picture.

Practice 1

“The website contains several images of the product.”

「網站上有幾張這件產品的圖片／圖像。」

Practice 2

“Click the image to enlarge it.”

「點擊這張圖片便可以放大。」

image = 以照片、繪圖或數碼方式呈現某人或某物外觀的視覺圖像

This broad sense includes:

photograph

drawing

digital image

scanned image

satellite image

These are contexts of the same core meaning, not separate lexical senses.

2. image = mental picture (腦海中的畫面) — 心像; 腦海中的形象 / 畫面

This is the core meaning in your sentence.

Meaning: A picture, scene, or representation formed in the mind rather than physically seen.

Practice 3 — Original

“That image really stayed with me.”

「那個鮮明的腦海畫面 / 意象一直令我印象深刻。」

Practice 4

“The story created a powerful image in my mind.”

「這個故事在我腦海中形成了一個非常鮮明的畫面。」

Practice 5

“I still have a clear image of the old house in my mind.”

「我腦海中仍然保留著那棟舊屋的清晰形象 / 畫面。」

mental image = 並非真正出現在眼前, 而是在腦海中形成的視覺性想像

3. image = figurative picture/idea created by language (比喻／描述產生的意象) — 意象; 形象化概念

This is especially relevant to your original passage.

Meaning: A vivid idea or picture created by words, metaphor, or description.

Practice 6

“The writer uses the image of a locked door to represent fear.”

「作者利用「鎖上的門」這個意象來代表恐懼。」

Practice 7

“The image of the city waking up gives the passage energy.”

「「城市甦醒」這個形象化意象令文章更有活力。」

image = 透過文字或比喻所建立的鮮明概念, 使讀者能在腦海中形成具體畫面

This is closely related to #2, but here the focus is specifically on language creating the image.

4. image = appearance/reputation presented to other people (公眾形象) — 形象; 給別人的印象

A major separate meaning.

Meaning: The way a person, company, organization, product, etc. is perceived by other people.

Practice 8

“The company is trying to improve its public image.”

「公司正在努力改善自己的公眾形象。」

Practice 9

“The advertisement helped create a more modern image for the brand.”

「這則廣告幫助品牌建立一個更加現代的品牌形象。」

image = 某人、品牌或機構在別人眼中所形成的整體印象

Common compounds:

public image = 公眾形象

brand image = 品牌形象

corporate image = 企業形象

professional image = 專業形象

5. self-image (對自己的看法) — 自我形象; 自我認知

Meaning: The picture or opinion someone has of themselves, including their appearance, abilities, personality, and worth.

Practice 10

“Social media can affect a teenager’s self-image.”

「社交媒體可能會影響青少年的自我形象／對自己的看法。」

Practice 11

“Success improved his self-image.”

「成功改善了他的自我認知和自我評價。」

self-image = 一個人對自己外表、能力、性格及價值的整體看法

6. image = reflection/likeness (倒影／相似形象) — 映像; 倒影; 相似形象

Meaning: A visual likeness or reproduction of something, especially one created by a mirror, lens, etc.

Practice 12

“She looked at her image in the mirror.”

「她看著鏡子裡自己的映像／倒影。」

Practice 13

“The lens produces a clear image.”

「這個鏡頭能形成清晰的影像。」

image = 某物經鏡子、鏡頭或其他方式形成的視覺映像

7. mirror image = exact/reversed counterpart (鏡像; 極相似的對應物) — 鏡像; 幾乎完全相同的對應物

Literal and figurative uses both occur.

Practice 14

“The design on the right is a mirror image of the one on the left.”

「右邊的設計是左邊那個設計的鏡像反轉版本。」

Practice 15

“Her career was almost a mirror image of her mother’s.”

「她的職業生涯幾乎是她母親的翻版／高度相似的對應版本。」

mirror image = 像鏡中倒影般反轉或高度對應的形象／事物

8. the image of + person/thing (非常相像) —的翻版; 酷似.....

Meaning: Looking extremely similar to someone or something.

Practice 16

“He is the image of his father.”

「他長得酷似父親, 簡直是父親的翻版。」

Practice 17

“She was the image of her mother at that age.”

「她在那個年紀時簡直就是母親的翻版。」

be the image of someone = 外貌或整體形象與某人非常相似

A very common related expression is:

the spitting image of someone

= 與某人長得幾乎一模一樣

9. image = digital/technical representation (數碼／技術上的完整影像資料) — 映像; 映像檔

In computing, image can mean a complete digital copy or representation.

Practice 18

“The technician created a disk image before replacing the drive.”

「技術人員更換硬碟前建立了一個完整的磁碟映像檔。」

Practice 19

“The system image can be used to restore the computer.”

「系統映像檔可以用來還原電腦。」

image = 以數碼形式保存某個系統、磁碟或資料內容的完整映像／副本

This is different from an ordinary photograph.

10. image + body part/object (醫學／科學) — 為……進行成像；取得影像

Here, image is a verb.

Meaning: To create a visual representation of something using medical, scientific, photographic, or electronic equipment.

Practice 20

“Doctors used MRI to image the patient’s brain.”

「醫生利用 MRI 為病人的腦部進行成像／取得影像。」

Practice 21

“The telescope can image extremely distant objects.”

「這台望遠鏡可以為極遙遠的天體取得影像。」

image something = 利用儀器把某物轉化成可觀察或分析的影像

11. imaging = process of producing images (成像技術／過程) — 成像；影像技術

Especially common in medicine and science.

Practice 22

“Medical imaging helps doctors examine internal organs.”

「醫學影像技術能幫助醫生檢查內部器官。」

Practice 23

“The clinic has modern diagnostic imaging equipment.”

「這間診所配備現代化的診斷成像設備。」

imaging = 利用技術產生身體、物件或其他目標影像的過程

Common examples:

medical imaging

diagnostic imaging

thermal imaging

satellite imaging

12. imagery = vivid descriptive language creating mental pictures(文字意象) — 意象; 形象化描寫

This is an especially useful family member for reading and writing.

Meaning: Language or artistic detail that creates vivid sensory or mental pictures.

Practice 24

“The poem uses powerful natural imagery.”

「這首詩運用了鮮明的自然意象。」

Practice 25

“The writer’s imagery makes the scene easy to visualize.”

「作者的形象化描寫令讀者很容易在腦海中想像場景。」

imagery = 透過文字、比喻或感官描寫, 在讀者腦中製造鮮明畫面的手法或意象集合

Important:

an image = 一個具體畫面／意象

imagery = 一整套／整體的形象化描寫手法

13. imagine + situation/person/action(想像) — 在腦海中設想; 想像

A useful family extension.

Meaning: To form a mental picture or idea of something that is not currently present or may not be real.

Practice 26

“Imagine sitting in complete silence on a crowded train.”

「想像一下自己坐在擠迫的火車上，卻完全聽不到周圍聲音。」

Practice 27

“I can’t imagine living without music.”

「我無法想像沒有音樂的生活。」

imagine = 在腦海中形成一個未必真正在眼前存在的情境或概念

14. imagination = ability to form new mental pictures/ideas(想像力) — 想像力

Practice 28

“Children often have vivid imaginations.”

「孩子通常有非常豐富的想像力。」

Practice 29

“The story captured my imagination.”

「這個故事深深吸引了我的想像力和思緒。」

imagination = 在腦海中創造、組合或設想事物、情境和概念的能力

15. imaginary = existing only in the imagination(想像中的;並非真實存在的) — 虛構的;想像中的

Practice 30

“The child has an imaginary friend.”

「那個孩子有一個想像中的朋友。」

Practice 31

“The story takes place in an imaginary country.”

「故事發生在一個虛構的國家。」

imaginary = 只存在於想像之中, 而非真實存在的

Important distinction: image vs picture
picture

Usually emphasizes a concrete visual representation.

"I took a picture of the city."

「我拍了一張城市的照片。」

image

Broader. It can mean:

picture
mental picture
public reputation
reflection
technical image

So:

"That image stayed with me."

is much more natural than interpreting it as:

"That photograph stayed with me."

because no photograph exists here.

Important distinction: image vs impression
image

Can be a vivid mental picture or a deliberately presented public identity.

impression

= the opinion or feeling formed about something.

"The advertisement gave me a good impression."

「這則廣告給我良好印象。」

“The image of the outside world being muted stayed with me.”

「外界被靜音的那個意象一直留在我腦海。」

So:

image → 腦海中的形象／畫面

impression → 對某事形成的感受或看法

Important distinction: image vs imagery

image

One particular picture or mental representation.

“the image of a closed door”

= 「關上的門」這個意象

imagery

The broader use of descriptive images in writing/art.

“The poem uses dark imagery.”

= 詩中大量使用陰暗的意象和形象化描寫。

Important distinction: image vs imagine

image

noun:

“I have a clear image in my mind.”

「我腦海中有一個清晰畫面。」

imagine

verb:

“Imagine a completely silent city.”

「想像一座完全安靜的城市。」

Important distinction: imaginary vs imaginative

These are very easy to confuse.

imaginary

= not real; existing only in imagination

“an imaginary creature”

「虛構的生物」

imaginative

= creative and good at producing new ideas

“an imaginative advertisement”

「很有創意的廣告」

So:

imaginary $\neq$ creative

Important distinction: image vs self-image

image

can mean how other people see you:

“his professional image”

「他在別人眼中的專業形象」

self-image

means how you see yourself:

“his self-image”

「他對自己的整體看法」

Family-extension note

Following our updated Golden Manual, these are especially useful:

mental image = 腦海中的畫面／心像

public image = 公眾形象

brand image = 品牌形象

self-image = 自我形象

mirror image = 鏡像／翻版

spitting image = 長得幾乎一模一樣的人

system/disk image = 系統／磁碟映像檔

medical imaging = 醫學影像／成像

imagery = 意象／形象化描寫

imagine = 想像

imagination = 想像力

imaginary = 想像中的／虛構的

Master comparison

Form / sense MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning

image — visual picture 以照片、繪圖或數碼方式呈現某人／某物外觀的視覺圖像

image — mental picture 並非真正出現在眼前，而是在腦海中形成的具體畫面

image — figurative/literary 透過文字或比喻建立、能讓人形成鮮明想像的意象

image — public reputation 某人、品牌或機構在別人眼中形成的整體形象

self-image 一個人對自己的外貌、能力、性格及價值的整體看法

image — reflection/likeness 經鏡子、鏡頭等形成的映像或相似形象

mirror image 像鏡中倒影般反轉或高度對應的版本

be the image of someone 外貌或整體形象與某人非常相似

system/disk image 以數碼形式保存系統或磁碟完整內容的映像副本

image — verb 利用醫療、科學或電子設備為某物產生可觀察影像

imaging 利用技術產生可分析影像的過程／技術

imagery 透過文字或藝術細節製造鮮明心像的描寫手法／意象

imagine 在腦海中設想並形成未必真實存在的情境或概念

imagination 在腦海中創造、組合或設想新情境和概念的能力

imaginary 只存在於想像中，而非真實存在的

For your original sentence

“That image really stayed with me.”

The exact meaning is:

image = 由前面的比喻在腦海中形成的鮮明畫面／意象

Specifically:

“someone had pressed a mute button on the outside world”

creates a mental picture of:

整個外界彷彿是一部有「靜音鍵」的機器，而戴上耳機就像把那個按鈕按下。

So:

That image really stayed with me.

= 那個鮮明的意象一直留在我的腦海中，令我久久不能忘記。